



7 min

(Don't Write anything in this Area)

Section A

Q.1) Comment on the following in about 150 words each:

10x5=50

(a) National Character Studies

According to Hans Kohn, national character is a totality of traditions, attitude and beliefs of national population so influential that it shapes the perception of nation both within & outside.

The National Character Studies emerged in the backdrop of World War II when American Government sponsored anthropologists to study the enemy nation Japan.

VARIOUS STUDIES:

1) RUTH Benedict: "Chrysanthemum and Sword"
 She shows how Japanese soldier's childhood was as smooth & loving as the chrysanthemum and equally troublesome & strict ~~was~~ their adulthood. Thus their aggression etc. was a result of such contrasting childhood experience.

2) Margaret Mead: "And Keep your Powder Dry", "Coming of Age in Samoa"
 She analysed Japanese, Russian & American

children whose personalities were same in childhood but differed later due to different enculturation practices.

3) Geoffrey Gorer : The submissive attitude of Russians is due to their swaddling practice in childhood.

Criticism

- 1) Can give way to new form of racism
- 2) Study "them" → studying "enemy" against Boasian ethics
- 3) Opler : "A nation can have many identities Ex: Lebanon."

Relevance

- 1) Business Anthropology studies of MNCs
- 2) Soft diplomacy & psychological war.

Thus National Character studies remain a significant contribution of the culture personality school.